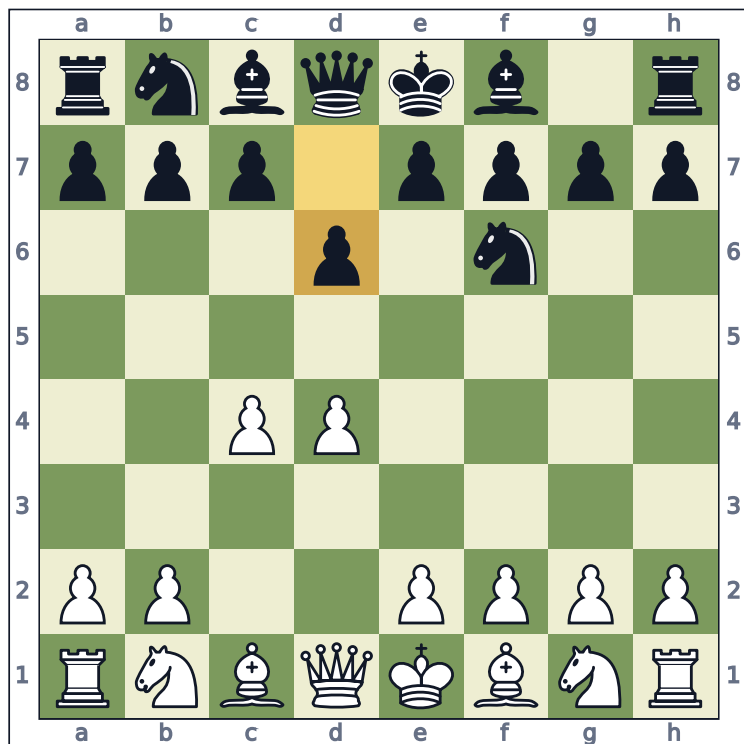


BENONI, BENKO, AND INDIAN STRUCTURES

Old Indian Defense

ECO A53 | 8 named lines in this code



Featured opening position - gold marks the last move

IS IT A GOOD OPENING?

Good and fully playable. The position remains within a normal opening balance for both sides.

ENGINE SNAPSHOT

+0.64 for White. A shallow opening score is a guide, not a forced result.

GAME CHARACTER

Principled and instructive: development and central breaks lead naturally into the middlegame.

WHAT THIS OPENING IS

A53 covers Old Indian Defense. The center becomes asymmetric: White often owns space, while Black seeks dynamic files, diagonals, and pawn breaks. The diagram uses the featured line Old Indian Defense.

DEFINING ROUTE

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 d6

UNDERSTAND THE POSITION

What both sides are trying to achieve

WHITE'S GOALS

Use the space advantage, finish development, support e4, and prepare a central or queenside expansion without overextending.

BLACK'S GOALS

Attack the pawn center with ...e6, ...c5, or ...b5, activate the dark-squared bishop, and create counterplay before White consolidates.

PAWN BREAKS - THE ENGINE OF THE OPENING

White commonly uses e5 or b4; Black's thematic resources include ...e6, ...b5, and sometimes ...f5.

PIECE MAP

White's central pawns need piece support. Black's bishops and rooks become strong when files open on the queenside. The central pawn placement should decide where each bishop and knight belongs.

WHAT USUALLY GOES WRONG

Space is valuable but can become a target. A premature pawn advance may leave weak squares behind it. Recheck the center after every opponent deviation; opening names do not make moves automatic.

POSITION SNAPSHOT

White moves next. Material is level. Central markers: White pawn on c4, White pawn on d4, Black pawn on d6.

WHO SHOULD STUDY IT?

Good for ambitious players: strategically rich and fully playable, but many lines require comfort with imbalance.

COMPLETE CODE CONTENTS

Every named A53 line

This section preserves all 8 names and defining routes assigned to A53 in the source catalogue. Different move orders can reach the same position; learn the structures and goals before memorizing labels.

001 Old Indian Defense

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 d6

002 Old Indian Defense: Aged Gibbon Gambit

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 d6 3. g4

003 Old Indian Defense: Czech Variation, with Nc3

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 d6 3. Nc3 c6

004 Old Indian Defense: Czech Variation, with Nf3

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 d6 3. Nf3 c6

005 Old Indian Defense: Janowski Variation

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 d6 3. Nc3 Bf5

006 Old Indian Defense: Janowski Variation, Fianchetto Variation

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 d6 3. Nc3 Bf5 4. g3

007 Old Indian Defense: Janowski Variation, Grinberg Gambit

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 d6 3. Nc3 Bf5 4. e4

008 Old Indian Defense: Janowski Variation, Main Line

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 d6 3. Nc3 Bf5 4. f3